

DEPARTMENT OF VETERANS AFFAIRS

**BRAND NAME ONLY Justification for Restricting Competition IAW RFO FAR
12.102(a) For
Over Micro-Purchase Threshold but Not Exceeding the Simplified Acquisition Threshold**

Acquisition Plan Action ID: 36C263-26-AP-2127

1. **Contracting Activity:** Department of Veterans Affairs, Network Contracting Office 23, 113 Comanche Rd., Fort Meade, SD 57741 for the VA Iowa City Health Care System, 601 Highway 6 West, Iowa City, IA 52246.

2237: 636-26-3-4154-0071

2. **Brief Description of Supplies/ Services required and the intended use/Estimated Amount:**

Estimated Amount: XXXXXXXXXX

Period of Performance: 120 DAY ARO

The Iowa City VA Health Care System (ICVAHCS) is requesting a training system that is a high-fidelity virtual reality simulator designed to train and assess ophthalmic surgeons in phacoemulsification and cataract surgery techniques under realistic, repeatable conditions. The system consists of both software and hardware capable of simulating cataract and vitreoretinal surgical procedures.

All equipment provided must be Brand Name Only by Haag-Streit. It must be new; and which includes all the software, hardware, and any accessories required to be fully operational. This requirement is also requesting professional installation and clinical education and on-site training.

3. **Unique characteristics that limit availability to only one source, with the reason no other supplies or services can be used:**

The VA Iowa City Healthcare System requires a Brand Name Only Haag-Streit Eyesi Surgical Cataract Simulator that is required due to its unique, proprietary capabilities that are essential to meeting the Government's minimum needs for ophthalmologic surgical training. This system is an integrated, high-fidelity simulation platform that combines specialized hardware, validated software, and haptic-enabled instrumentation to replicate real world cataract surgery with the level of realism necessary for resident training and skills assessment.

Key distinguishing characteristics include realistic microsurgical simulation with tactical feedback, curriculum-based training modules aligned with ophthalmology, residency programs, quantitative performance metrics for objective assessment, and proven track record in ophthalmic surgical education. These features are designed as a single, proprietary system and are not available as separate or interchangeable components from other sources.

Due to the proprietary design, integration of system components, and the requirement for validated, high-fidelity surgical simulation to support training and evaluation, no other supplies or services will satisfy the government's minimum needs. Accordingly, only Haag-Streit Eyesi Surgical Cataract Simulator can meet the requirement.

Description of market research conducted and results or statement why it was not conducted:

- a. Conducted a search on the U.S. Small Business Administration using 339113 that resulted in 1303 results.
- b. Searched the General Services Administration (GSA) Advantage using keywords "P-NES Set CAT IC 36" and "HS Simulation Eyesi Surgical Cataract System 36m" for one of the items listed to procure. Contracting Officer searched all items numbers with zero results.
- c. Searched GSA eLibrary for Haag-Streit USA Inc. This produced zero results. Searched for Corps Medical Supply LLC.
- d. Posted a Sources Sought (36C26326Q0569) from 04/13/2026 – 04/23/2026 and received the following vendors response.
 - i. Corps Medical Supply LLC. – Authorized Distributor – Service-Disabled Veteran Owned Small Business (SDVOSB)
- e. Conducted a Repts and Cert search on SAM, the following are the results for NAICS Code 339113:
 - i. Haag-Streit USA Inc. – Manufacture – Large Business
 - ii. Corps Medical Supply LLC. – Authorized Distributor – Service-Disabled Veteran Owned Small Business (SDVOSB)
- f. Sent an email to Corps Medical Supply LLC. and asked where these items were manufactured. Corps Medical Supply LLC. stated that component parts are manufactured in Germany. During installation on-site the component parts are assembled into a working Surgical Simulator (

operating microscope, foot pedal, hand pieces, wiring etc.). The software is then update and installed on site, the simulator is tested and adjusted and when this is completed the simulator is turned over to the facility for use. Therefore this is considered to be made in the USA.

4. Contracting Officer's Certification:

Purchase is approved in accordance with FAR 12.102(a). I certify that the foregoing justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

**DENNIS
SALMONSEN**
SIGNATURE: _____

Digitally signed by
DENNIS SALMONSEN
Date: 2026.04.23
15:00:06 -06'00'

Dennis Salmonsen
Contracting Officer